VEL
SOFTWARE SOLUTIONS

COMPANY OPERATING SYSTEM

# Project Discovery Questionnaire

Structured questions for client discovery meetings

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Tool versions, limits and vendor prices change. Always verify against official documentation and pricing calculators before building or quoting.

# Table of Contents

Project Discovery Questionnaire ..... 3

# Project Discovery Questionnaire

Send this questionnaire to the client two days before the discovery meeting. Complete it **with** the client during the meeting; record answers, assumptions and open questions. Unknown answers are recorded as "TBD - owner - due date", never guessed.

| Project | Client | Date |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

## Part 1 - Lead qualification (internal, Stage 1)

| Criterion | Question | Score 1-5 |
|---|---|---|
| **Budget** | Is there an approved budget range? | |
| **Authority** | Who decides and who pays? Are they in the meeting? | |
| **Need** | Is the problem clear and valuable to the business? | |
| **Timeline** | Is there a real deadline and a reason for it? | |
| **Fit** | Is it within our services and skills? Any ethical/legal red flags? | |
| **Total (pass at 15 or more)** | | |

## Part 2 - Business

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | What does the business do? Who are the customers? | |
| 2 | Why a new site/system now? What problem does it solve? | |
| 3 | What does success look like in 6 and 12 months (numbers)? | |
| 4 | Who are the target users? Devices and locations? Languages? | |
| 5 | Who are the main competitors? Which sites do you admire and why? | |
| 6 | What is unique about your offer? | |
| 7 | Any brand guidelines, logo files, colours, tone of voice? | |
| 8 | Who will provide text, photos, product data? By when? | |

## Part 3 - Functional

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 9 | Pages / sections needed (list)? | |
| 10 | User accounts? Roles (visitor, customer, staff, admin)? | |
| 11 | Key user journeys (enquiry, booking, purchase, download...)? | |

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 12 | Forms and what happens after submission (e-mail, CRM, database)? | |
| 13 | Content management - who updates what, how often? | |
| 14 | E-commerce - products, variants, stock, shipping, tax, coupons, invoices? | |
| 15 | Booking - services, durations, staff, calendar, reminders, cancellations? | |
| 16 | Payments - methods, currencies, refunds, which gateway? Who owns the account? | |
| 17 | Reports, exports, dashboards needed? | |
| 18 | Search, filters, multilingual, notifications, chat? | |

## Part 4 - Technical

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Existing website/system? URL, platform, hosting, access, what must be kept? | |
| 20 | Domain name - who owns it, where is DNS, e-mail provider in use? | |
| 21 | Third-party systems to integrate (ERP, CRM, accounting, SMS/WhatsApp, analytics)? Do APIs exist? | |
| 22 | Expected traffic now and in 12 months; peak events (sales, campaigns)? | |
| 23 | Browsers/devices that must be supported? | |
| 24 | Hosting preferences or restrictions (country, provider, client's cloud account)? | |
| 25 | Existing data to migrate (volume, quality, format)? | |
| 26 | Who will maintain the system after launch? | |

## Part 5 - Non-functional, security and compliance

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 27 | Data collected - personal, financial, health, children's data? | |
| 28 | Applicable laws or standards (privacy, e-commerce, accessibility, industry rules)? | |
| 29 | Required availability (uptime) and tolerated downtime? | |
| 30 | Acceptable data loss (RPO) and recovery time (RTO)? | |
| 31 | Accessibility requirement (WCAG 2.2 AA?) | |
| 32 | SEO requirements - current rankings, redirects needed, target keywords? | |
| 33 | Performance expectations? | |
| 34 | Cookie consent, privacy policy, terms - who prepares them? | |

## Part 6 - Commercial and project

| # | Question | Answer |
|---|---|---|
| 35 | Budget range and payment preferences? | |
| 36 | Launch date and reason for it; any hard dependencies (event, campaign)? | |
| 37 | Who is the single decision-maker and who gives day-to-day feedback? | |
| 38 | How fast can the client review and respond (days)? | |
| 39 | Support and maintenance expectations after launch? | |
| 40 | Anything we have not asked that we should know? | |

## Output of the meeting

| Item | Owner | Due |
|---|---|---|
| **Meeting minutes sent for confirmation (within 24 h)** | PM | |
| **Assumptions and open questions list** | PM | |
| **Problem statement confirmed in writing (Gate 02)** | Client | |
| **Requirements document started (Appendix A4)** | PM / TL | |